

# Ireland

Sovereign government data centre network — capacity, legal posture, provider landscape and migration path.

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## 1 Starting point

|                                |               |
|--------------------------------|---------------|
| Population                     | 5.44 m        |
| GDP                            | EUR 602 bn    |
| Public administration (NACE O) | 144 k         |
| Electricity price              | 255.2 EUR/MWh |
| Renewables                     | 41.3%         |
| Live hyperscaler regions       | 2             |

## 2 What is structurally different

- Grid isolation. The national grid is an electrical island or nearly so (weak or single interconnection). The April 2025 Iberian blackout and Cyprus/Malta interconnector outages show the failure mode. Every site needs on-site generation and storage sized for multi-day ride-through, and the PUE and facility CAPEX assumptions should be revisited upward once site studies exist.
- Expensive power (255 EUR/MWh vs. EU average ~184). Power is the dominant OPEX line; free cooling, heat reuse, and siting near renewables or nuclear baseload move the economics more than server choice does. The model's power OPEX line is the number to attack first.

## 3 Capacity

|                      |                                           |
|----------------------|-------------------------------------------|
| Servers              | 2,026 (CPU 1,338 / GPU 125 / storage 563) |
| IT critical load     | 3.5 MW                                    |
| Facility design load | 5.3 MW                                    |

|                   |                                       |
|-------------------|---------------------------------------|
| Sites             | 3 (by capacity 1, floor 3)            |
| Average per site  | 1.8 MW                                |
| Site count set by | the minimum-sites floor, not capacity |
| CAPEX             | EUR 131 m                             |
| OPEX              | EUR 16 m / yr                         |

## 4 Proposed geography

| Region                   | Role                    | Share | MW  | Notes                                                                             |
|--------------------------|-------------------------|-------|-----|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Dublin                   | Primary civil cloud     | 41%   | 2.2 | OGCIO/Backweston estate, INEX; EirGrid connection moratorium to ~2028 is binding. |
| Cork                     | Sovereign secondary     | 27%   | 1.4 | Atlantic cable landings (Kinsale, Amitie), Celtic Interconnector.                 |
| Galway - Limerick / West | Government / continuity | 23%   | 1.2 | Wind surplus, AEC-1 landing (Killala).                                            |
| Midlands / Athlone       | Strategic reserve       | 10%   | 0.5 | Post-peat land and grid; reserve/expansion.                                       |

*First-pass geographic hypotheses encoding only the obvious constraints, to be replaced by scored site selection.*

## 5 Legal and regulatory posture

|                      |                                                                                         |
|----------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Governing instrument | Public Service ICT Strategy and OGCIO cloud-first policy; no sovereignty carve-out      |
| Cloud certification  | No national scheme; ISO 27001                                                           |
| Data classification  | Official Secrets Act; departmental classification rather than a single statutory ladder |
| Procurement route    | Office of Government Procurement (OGP)                                                  |

**Foreign jurisdiction exposure.** Highest exposure in the EU-27: AWS eu-west-1 and Azure North Europe are both anchored in Dublin and government is a direct consumer under a cloud-first policy with no sovereignty carve-out

Under the US CLOUD Act and FISA 702 a provider subject to US jurisdiction can face a lawful order for data it holds regardless of where that data sits. Residency is necessary but not sufficient; what matters is who holds the keys and who can be compelled.

## 6 Current state and provider landscape

|                  |                                                                                                                                                                           |
|------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Government cloud | No sovereign cloud; OGCIO Build to Share + Government Cloud Network + Backweston government DCs; cloud-first Advice Note; Digital Decade 2025 report flags DC grid limits |
| Maturity         | pilot                                                                                                                                                                     |
| Digital identity | MyGovID (Public Services Card)                                                                                                                                            |
| Interconnection  | INEX Dublin/Cork; Atlantic landings Killala Kinsale Cork                                                                                                                  |

## 7 Migration path and cost

| Phase | Scope          | MW  | CAPEX    | Cumulative | Hybrid |
|-------|----------------|-----|----------|------------|--------|
| 1     | Sovereign core | 0.9 | EUR 17 m | 13%        | no     |

| Phase | Scope                | MW  | CAPEX    | Cumulative | Hybrid |
|-------|----------------------|-----|----------|------------|--------|
| 2     | Security and defense | 1.2 | EUR 30 m | 35%        | no     |
| 3     | State record         | 1.0 | EUR 26 m | 55%        | no     |
| 4     | Elective             | 2.2 | EUR 59 m | 100%       | yes    |

Phase 1 is the number that matters: **EUR 17 m** for 0.9 MW, 13% of total CAPEX. That is the floor below which no hybrid arrangement helps — and it is a small fraction of the full build.

## 8 Geography and threat notes

Negligible seismic; Atlantic storm/coastal and river floods; GRID IS BINDING: EirGrid Dublin DC connection moratorium to ~2028, DCs ~21% of national electricity; most expensive EU power; single UK gas pipeline until Celtic Interconnector (~2027); neutral non-NATO; subsea cable vulnerability

## 9 Critical national data in scope

What the platform would *hold*, tiered by consequence of loss rather than by department. Tier 0 is the identity spine; tier 1 is the enforceable relationship between citizen and state. **0 of 15 record classes recorded.**

| Tier | Record class                 | Register                | Official description |
|------|------------------------------|-------------------------|----------------------|
| 0    | Civil registry core          | <i>not yet recorded</i> |                      |
| 0    | Facial biometric             | <i>not yet recorded</i> |                      |
| 0    | Fingerprint biometric        | <i>not yet recorded</i> |                      |
| 0    | Breeder document scans       | <i>not yet recorded</i> |                      |
| 0    | Document issuance history    | <i>not yet recorded</i> |                      |
| 0    | Digital identity credentials | <i>not yet recorded</i> |                      |
| 0    | Authentication audit log     | <i>not yet recorded</i> |                      |
| 0    | Electoral roll entry         | <i>not yet recorded</i> |                      |
| 1    | Tax                          | <i>not yet recorded</i> |                      |
| 1    | Benefits & pensions          | <i>not yet recorded</i> |                      |
| 1    | Land & property registry     | <i>not yet recorded</i> |                      |
| 1    | Judicial & criminal justice  | <i>not yet recorded</i> |                      |
| 1    | Education                    | <i>not yet recorded</i> |                      |
| 1    | Business registry            | <i>not yet recorded</i> |                      |

| Tier | Record class        | Register                | Official description |
|------|---------------------|-------------------------|----------------------|
| 1    | Vehicle & licensing | <i>not yet recorded</i> |                      |

A blank row means this repository has not yet researched that register. It is not a statement that the country holds no such data. Tiers 2 (health records, imaging) and 3 (genomics, archives, video retention, geospatial) are out of scope: they hold most of the bytes, but Tiers 0 and 1 hold the sovereignty.